

Buddy Guide

Progressive hints, not answers

Client	Generation Bridge Foundation
Document reference	Facilitator pack
Classification	FACILITATOR ONLY - do not distribute
Version	3.1 July-September 2026

Your job is to ask better questions, not to solve the case. Never name 'efficiency versus ethics' or 'elitist outside-in' to participants. Use the three-level hint ladder. Only move to the next level if the team is genuinely stuck.

Staff-only: the A↔B loop (Buddy + 5 only)

Week 3 energy comes from inside the team room. Referee this sequence:

1. B presents Data Estate Brief (catalog) - stop them if they open the Excel for A.
2. A presents Demand Brief (ranked decision needs) - stop column shopping lists.
3. B owns Analysis Plan - A may clarify scope/timing, not rewrite joins.
4. Then formal R-xx -> FM-xx as the assessment trail.

Staff-only: question themes (do not paste into participant packs)

Participants should invent asks from transcripts and their issue tree. If they only request vanity metrics from D-01, nudge - do not hand them a menu. Useful pressure-tests often include:

- What actually moves placement (attendance, programme design, or something else)?
- Whether mentoring intensity, completion or volunteer capacity matches how staff and young people describe it.
- Ask only what would change the recommendation - not everything.

These themes live here so Buddies can guide discovery. They were removed from Workflow A's brief so teams are not spoon-fed the analysis agenda.

The hint ladder

Problem framing

1. Level 1: What exactly must the Board decide on 10 September - in one sentence of your own?
2. Level 2: Which disagreements in the data room would change that sentence if resolved?
3. Level 3: Ask which voices pull hardest in opposite directions, and whether your tree covers them.

Asking for evidence

1. Level 1: What would you need to know to choose between your options?
2. Level 2: Have you read B's Data Estate Brief and filed a Demand Brief - or are you guessing from the annual report?
3. Level 3: Ask A to turn one Demand item into R-0x after B's Analysis Plan exists.

Data Estate / Demand / Plan hygiene

1. Level 1: Where is the Data Estate Brief PDF?
2. Level 2: Is Demand ranked by decision impact, or is it a list of columns?
3. Level 3: Refuse raw-file sharing; require DEB -> DMD -> AP -> R/FM PDFs in A_B_Exchange/.

Drivers of placement / attendance

1. Level 1: Staff and young people talk about what helps someone get a job - have you tested any of that?
2. Level 2: Would attendance or programme design change your recommendation if the data disagreed?
3. Level 3: Nudge A toward a Demand item on placement drivers; then coach B on the Analysis Plan without giving the steps.

Mentoring / completion / volunteers

1. Level 1: Transcripts mention mentoring and drop-out - is that a claim or an evidence gap?
2. Level 2: What would you ask B if mentoring intensity mattered for your option?
3. Level 3: If B is stuck: which tables mention mentors or completion? What would you exclude before averaging?

A_B_Exchange hygiene

1. Level 1: Where is the PDF of that request?
2. Level 2: Is the Findings Memo in A_B_Exchange/ or only in a chat thread?
3. Level 3: Refuse to treat chat as the official record; require R-xx / FM-xx PDFs before handoff.

Handoff confirmation

1. Level 1: Where is the Cross-Workflow Handoff Checklist in the package?
2. Level 2: Have A and B each completed their section with an online tick (name + date) - not a wet signature?
3. Level 3: Point them to 4_Shared_Toolkit/Templates/Cross_Workflow_Handoff_Checklist.docx and Guideline Section 8; Engagement Lead confirms Section C only if three R/FM pairs exist.

Placement rate

1. Level 1: What does 'placed' actually mean here?
2. Level 2: Whose definition are you using - D-01's or ST-02's?
3. Level 3: Have B compute both the broad and the formal rate and return them via a Findings Memo.

Recommendations

1. Level 1: What is the evidence for that claim?
2. Level 2: Which transcript or Findings Memo backs this up?
3. Level 3: Ask them to map every recommendation to a source in the validation protocol, including R-/FM- IDs.

Costs of the choice

1. Level 1: Who gains under your recommendation?
2. Level 2: Who waits longer, or is deprioritised, if you choose this path?
3. Level 3: Point them to the trade-off reflection without naming the dilemma for them.

Coaching B on deep-dive requests (staff only)

Participant packs no longer prescribe DB-3/DB-4 methods. When B receives a request about attendance, placement drivers, mentoring or completion:

1. Ask them to restate A's decision question in one sentence.
2. Ask which tables in the data dictionary look relevant - do not name the join path first.
3. If still stuck, Level 2: 'How would you get one attendance rate per young person?' or 'What would you do with hours logged against inactive mentors?'
4. Level 3 (last resort): point them to Facilitators/PDF/05_Data_Task_Solutions.pdf for method hints - do not read the expected findings aloud.
5. Always push: association is not causation; name confounders in the Findings Memo.

Check-in schedule

Fridays of Weeks 1-7. Fifteen minutes (longer in Week 3 if running the Estate/Demand/Plan live brief). Review Request Log milestones, Findings Memo quality, and whether claims are cited. Do not review answers for correctness. Do not give A the dataset. From Week 3, check Estate -> Demand -> Plan before R-01. From Week 5, confirm the team knows where the Handoff Checklist lives and that confirmation is online only (W6-02).

Common mistakes to expect

- Accepting the 71% placement rate at face value.
- A reverse-engineering strategy from D-01 without Demand / querying B.
- B sharing the raw workbook, dictionary, or a field dump labelled as Estate Brief.
- A writing Demand as a column shopping list; B letting A co-edit the Analysis Plan.
- A never asking about attendance, mentoring or completion despite transcript clues.
- Recommending national scale without fixing Dong Nai.
- Treating the board email (D-08) as fact.
- Claiming attendance causes placement.
- Empty trade-off reflection; no named cost of the preferred path.
- Leaving the Handoff Checklist to the night before the Board, or treating chat 'we agreed' as confirmation.